“the anarchists”; Shabtai praised his Jerusalem colleague for showing common sense. Will Ben-Gvir attempt to dismiss him?

Friday, February 10

Another terror assault in Jerusalem: two children dead, a six-year-old and an eight-year-old (who died three days later), and five people wounded. The terrorist, a Palestinian from East Jerusalem, rammed his car into a group waiting at a bus station. He apparently is a psychiatric patient. Of course, Ben-Gvir has been calling for the wildest retaliation measures, all of these completely pointless against a single offender, according to counter-terror specialists. Such crazy steps can only inflame the situation.

An unnamed senior member of the coalition strongly criticizes Ben-Gvir: “One cannot announce retaliation measures from the sidewalk.” Fine, but he is wrong: Ben-Gvir loves sidewalk announcements, the more incendiary the better; it adds to his visibility and will garner him votes when elections come. People forget who Ben-Gvir is. Do you remember who was a master of outrageous proclamations that drew increasing masses of voters? We dislike some historical comparisons, but we cannot remain completely blind to lessons from the past.

This being said, one cannot skip the fact that Hamas and Islamic Jihad celebrated the attack and that there was quite some militant excitement in several West Bank towns. All this is possibly a preparation for the Ramadan which, this year, starts on March 22.

Saturday, February 11

The Tel Aviv municipality building hung a banner over its front with the full text of the Independence Declaration of May 1948, a model of democratic principles.